

## **Subject Description Form**

|                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
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| <b>Subject Code</b>                                              | <b>ITC4068M</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Subject Title</b>                                             | <b>Merchandising Management</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Credit Value</b>                                              | <b>3 credits</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Level</b>                                                     | <b>4</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Pre-requisite/<br/>&lt;Co-requisite&gt; /<br/>(Exclusion)</b> | ITC2015M Fashion Supply Chain Management                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Objectives</b>                                                | The subject is to provide students with a deep understanding of planning and control issues in managing the fashion and textile merchandise supply within globalizing business contexts. The subject will also develop students' competence of communication and coordination amongst globally dispersed merchandising teams                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Intended Learning Outcomes</b>                                | <p>Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>a. manage merchandising process and communication activities amongst globally dispersed merchandising function teams;</li> <li>b. analyse and develop trade and ethical compliance requirements for supplier selections;</li> <li>c. design and specify control mechanisms and logistics to monitor global supply operations;</li> <li>d. formulate solutions to resolve contingent problems and crisis in international merchandising businesses;</li> <li>e. demonstrate strong leadership skills amongst well-partitioned functional merchandising teams.</li> </ol>                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Subject Synopsis/<br/>Indicative Syllabus</b>                 | <p><b>(I) Merchandising Function in Supply Chain</b><br/>Operational duties in merchandising function;<br/>Responsibility of management in international merchandising organizations</p> <p><b>(II) Merchandising as Process-based Workflow Management and Its Planning Functions</b><br/>Activity workflow design and evaluation;<br/>Business and merchandise development ;<br/>Product cost management;<br/>Sourcing and vendor management;<br/>Merchandising information requirement</p> <p><b>(III) Trade Formalities</b><br/>Contract formation and provisions;<br/>Financing methods and transaction settlement;<br/>Documents and transport chartering activities;</p> <p><b>(IV) Strategic Merchandising Practices</b><br/>Internationally recognized compliance standards and implementation requirements;<br/>Cost and information control mechanisms;</p> |

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|--|
|                                                                        | Designer and store branding processes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |  |
|                                                                        | <b>(V) Merchandising Technologies</b><br>e-sourcing practices and business models;<br>Mass customization approaches<br>Information and Communication technologies (ICTs) in fashion business                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |  |
| <b>Teaching/Learning Methodology</b>                                   | The learning process consists of lectures, tutorials and self-learning components. In lectures, conceptual elements and updated knowledge in merchandising practices will be organized and presented as in case-based learning materials. Tutorial classes allow students to reinforce the concepts and principles cognitively through in-depth discussions and sharing. Students are confronted with real life management problems in global oriented merchandising tasks.                                                                      |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |  |
| <b>Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes</b> | Specific assessment methods/tasks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | % weighting | Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate) |   |   |   |   |  |
|                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |             | a                                                                              | b | c | d | e |  |
|                                                                        | 1. Coursework                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 50%         |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |  |
|                                                                        | 2. Examination                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 50%         |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |  |
|                                                                        | Total                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 100%        |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |  |
|                                                                        | Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:<br><br>Coursework mainly assesses students’ intellectual competence in recognising problems, analyses and formulating solutions.<br><br>In contrast, examination is to assess students’ problem solving skills and responses to challenges in questions, which is restricted by conditions in examination environment. Says, demonstrating leadership and coordination skills are not appropriate being assessed in examination halls. |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |  |
| <b>Student Study Effort Expected</b>                                   | Class contact:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |  |
|                                                                        | • Lecture                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |             | 26 Hrs.                                                                        |   |   |   |   |  |
|                                                                        | • Tutorial/ Studio                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |             | 12 Hrs.                                                                        |   |   |   |   |  |
|                                                                        | Other student study effort:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |  |
|                                                                        | • Assignments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |             | 66 Hrs.                                                                        |   |   |   |   |  |
|                                                                        | Total student study effort                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |             | 104 Hrs.                                                                       |   |   |   |   |  |
| <b>Reading List and References</b>                                     | <b><u>Books</u></b><br>Kunz, G.I. (2004). <i>Merchandising: Theory, Principles and Practices, 2<sup>nd</sup> Ed Fairchild</i> .<br>Regan, C.L. (2007). <i>Apparel Product Design and Merchandising Strategies</i> . Upper Saddle River [N.J.]: Pearson/Prentice Hall.<br>Rosenau, J. and David, W. (2006). <i>Apparel Merchandising: The Line Starts Here</i> . New York: Fairchild Publications.                                                                                                                                                |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |  |

**Supplementary**

Johnson, M.J. and Moore, E.C. (2001). *Apparel Product Development*. Prentice Hall.

Frings, G.S. (2009). *Fashion: from Concept to Consumer*, 9<sup>th</sup> Edit Prentice Hall, New York.

Stewart, B.L. and Kemp-Gatterson, B. (2009). *Apparel: Concepts and Practical Applications*. New York: Fairchild Publications.

Jacobsen, M. L. (2009). *The Art of Retail Buying: An Insider's Guide to the Best Practices from the Industry*, John Wiley & Sons (Asia).

**Journals**

Apparel International

Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management

Store

Textile Outlook International